

41 Short answers

When answering closed questions in English, some words can often be left out to make responses shorter. These short answers are often used in spoken English.

See also:

Present simple 1 Types of verbs 49

Modal verbs 56 "There" 85

41.1 SHORT ANSWERS

When the question uses the verb "be," "be" is used in the same tense in the short answer. When the question uses the auxiliary verb "do," "do" is used in the same tense in the short answer.

Question uses "be."

Are you a doctor?

Yes, **I am.**

No, **I'm not.**

"A doctor" doesn't need to be repeated in the answer.



Question uses "do."

Do you like coffee?

Yes, **I do.**

No, **I don't.**

"Like coffee" doesn't need to be repeated in the answer.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

Is your name Sophie?

Yes, **it is.**

Are you having fun?

Yes, **I am.**

Was the train on time?

No, **it wasn't.**

Does he live here?

Yes, **he does.**

Do you like cake?

Yes, **I do.**

Did you enjoy the play?

No, **I didn't.**